

ENGLISH

COMPREHENSION & VOCABULARY

UPSC / BANK PO / SSC / OTHERS

SESSION - 3

11th January, 2017 @ 12.00 noon

Democracy, Diversity, Development

2016 was dominated by their dark sides, can we channel the Force this year?

Samir Saran



2016 was witness to dramatic political changes. Everything that seemed improbable, even unthinkable somehow found new ways of manifesting itself, and that too repeatedly.

The impregnable walls of the European Union (EU) were breached when its largest security provider, Britain, decided to break free from the European project. A celebrity of a reality TV show was able to capture the imagination of a frustrated American public and walked away with a near impossible victory in presidential elections.

Liberal actors and voices were constantly defeated in many arenas by populist movements. The new energy of right-wing forces in several geographies competed with the new fanaticism among Islamic radicals. The defeat of liberalism defined the mood and events of 2016.

More than any year in the recent past, 2016 signified a metamorphosis of the global order itself. 2017 therefore becomes a very significant year as it brings together two unknowns for all of us to grapple with.

First is the future of global economics and financial systems, which are yet to be adequately restructured following the crises of 2008. Second are the political questions raised by the happenings of the year gone by. Both of these will have to be addressed discretely and jointly, if gains of the post-war order are to be maintained and strengthened.

Three, words must receive significant attention this year as we respond to the economic and political challenges that lie ahead: democracy, diversity and development. All three are today under threat, and all three by themselves are a threat to global stability.

THE TIMES OF INDIA

10th January 2017



DISCUSSION ON
11th Jan (today)



DISCUSSION ON
12th Jan (tomorrow)

Go Ahead and Sell Off Non-Strategic PSUs

The government appears to be unlikely to push ahead with its divestment plan in the current fiscal due to a choppy market and the comfortable revenue position. It shows complacency and defeats the goal of boosting the performance of state-owned enterprises. The government must proactively sell shares of profit-making state-owned companies that are not strategic any more. The stake sales need not have to wait for the right level of stock prices. Large-scale disinvestment in these PSUs will help shore up their performance. The case for the government to exit sectors such as steel and power is compelling, given that the private sector has developed technical and managerial capability to operate in these areas.



The government should foray into new sectors—advanced manufacturing in microelectronics, aerospace, telecom and new-generation drugs—where the private sector does not have the requisite expertise and capability. A dynamic approach is needed for the government to create companies that get into serious R&D,

akin to state-owned CDoT that showed promise to boost indigenous telecom R&D. It should also swiftly wind up loss making companies and use the money garnered through reshuffling assets as capital investment to build infrastructure that the country badly needs.

Of the budgeted target of ₹56,500 crore this fiscal year, the government has so far raised about ₹21,432 crore through share buyback in companies that include Coal India, Nalco, HCL, NHPC, NMDC and BEL, apart from ₹2,096 crore as part-sale of its holding in Specified Undertaking of the UTI (SUUTI). Three-fourths of the amount has been raised by buybacks, which preclude some public holding in these companies, generating some additional pressure to perform and be transparent.

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

29th December 2016



LEARNING SPACE

...Transforming Human Lives

Democracy, Diversity, Development

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Democracy, Diversity, Development

Article

NEWSPAPER EDITOR, LUCKNOW OFFICE | NATIONAL THOUGHT LEADERSHIP
THE TIMES OF INDIA
100 YEARS OF INDEPENDENCE

10th January 2017



LEARNING SPACE

...Transforming Human Lives

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Democracy, Diversity, Development

2016 was witness to *dramatic* political changes. Everything that seemed *improbable*, even unthinkable somehow found new ways of *manifesting* itself, and that too repeatedly.

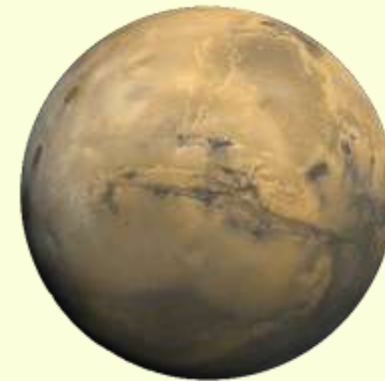
IMPOSSIBLE

It is impossible to
live on Sun



IMPROBABLE

It is improbable to
live on Mars



Democracy, Diversity, Development

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DEBIT CARD BREACH



SECURITY BREACH



Democracy, Diversity, Development

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HINDU



MUSLIM



CHRISTIAN



GOVTS POPULIST MEASURES



LEFT WING EXTREMISM / RADICALS



LEFT WING



- Communists
- Socialists

RIGHT WING



- Conservatives
- Traditionalists
- Capitalists

RIGHT WING EXTREMISM

FAR - RIGHT

- Extreme Nationalism
- Opposing immigration
- Nativism

**EXTREME BELIEF WITH
LITTLE TOLERANCE TO
CONTRARY IDEAS OR
OPINIONS**



Democracy, Diversity, Development

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Life Cycle Metamorphosis



Egg



Caterpillar



Chrysalis



Butterfly

Butterfly Life Cycle

Democracy, Diversity, Development

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India



USA



China



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